PARENT & CARER INFORMATION · YEAR 9–10

Advanced Water Safety Parent & Carer Information

Your son or daughter is completing the Advanced Water Safety unit in Health & Physical Education. This sheet tells you what they're learning, how they'll be assessed, and how you can support them at home.

Year 9–10 HPE | Victorian Curriculum 2.0 | VC2HP10P02–VC2HP10P09 · VC2HP10M01

SCHOOL	TEACHER	TERM / YEAR

📚 What Is Your Child Learning?

The Advanced Water Safety unit builds on the Year 7–8 program. At this level, students move beyond learning the rules to **analysing why water safety problems exist and what can be done about them**. This develops critical thinking, research skills, and health literacy.

- **Victorian & global drowning data** — students learn to calculate and interpret drowning rate statistics using real Victorian Government data
- **Physiology of drowning** — how drowning affects the body, why CPR within 4 minutes is critical, cold water shock, and secondary drowning
- **Social determinants of drowning risk** — why some groups (males, CALD communities, rural communities) are at higher risk, and how structural factors drive this
- **Prevention strategy evaluation** — assessing what actually works to prevent drowning, and why, with reference to evidence
- **International comparison** — comparing Australian water safety approaches to those used in the UK and USA

Why does this matter at Year 9–10? Young people aged 15–24 are one of Victoria's highest-risk groups for drowning. The knowledge and decision-making skills developed in this unit are

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directly relevant to the situations your child will face in the years ahead — at beaches, rivers, pools, and social gatherings near water.

📝 How Will My Child Be Assessed?

Students complete a **summative assessment task** that asks them to apply their unit knowledge in a real-world communication format. They choose one of three options:

Option A — Policy Brief

600–800 words addressed to the Victorian Minister for Sport, with two evidence-based recommendations and measurable success metrics.

Option B — Awareness Campaign

A designed campaign targeting one high-risk group, with a 100-word justification of design choices and evidence base.

Option C — School Audit ★

An audit of the school's water safety provision benchmarked against Victorian Curriculum requirements, with recommendations.

A rubric is provided to students at the start of the unit so they know exactly what is expected. It assesses six criteria — data analysis, physiological knowledge, social determinants analysis, prevention strategy evaluation, international comparison, and communication product quality.

🏠 How Can I Support My Child at Home?

You don't need to be a water safety expert to support this unit. The most valuable thing you can do is **have conversations about water safety** — it reinforces what they're learning and makes it personally relevant.

Try asking:

💬 "What did you find most surprising about the Victorian drowning data?"

💬 "Why do you think young men are more likely to drown than young women?"

💬 "What would you do if you saw someone drowning at the beach?"

💬 "What makes a river or dam more dangerous than a patrolled beach?"

💬 "If you had $5 million to reduce drowning in Victoria, what would you do?"

💬 "What's the difference between how Australia and the UK teach water safety?"

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- **For the assessment task:** encourage your child to start early, visit the recommended websites listed in their workbook, and read their draft before submitting
- **If they seem stuck:** ask them to explain their argument out loud — often talking it through helps clarify thinking
- **Research support:** key websites are lsv.com.au, royallifesaving.com.au, and who.int — all free and publicly accessible

🏊 "My child can swim well — why do they still need this unit?"

This is a common and understandable question. The answer is that the vast majority of Victorian drowning victims could swim. **Drowning is rarely caused by inability to swim** — it's caused by:

- Swimming in conditions beyond one's ability (rip currents, cold water)
- Swimming at unpatrolled locations without supervision
- Alcohol and risk-taking behaviour near water
- Not knowing how to respond in an emergency
- Structural barriers — communities that grew up without swim access

This unit develops the **critical thinking and decision-making skills** that swimming ability alone cannot provide — and that directly affect survival outcomes.

🔗 Key Resources & Contacts

🏄

Life Saving Victoria

lsv.com.au

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Royal Life Saving Australia

royallifesaving.com.au

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BeachSafe App

beachsafe.org.au

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St John Ambulance

stjohnvic.com.au

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WHO Drowning Data

who.int

📋

Victorian Curriculum

vcaa.vic.edu.au

✂ Please return this section to your child's teacher by: _____

STUDENT NAME PARENT / CARER NAME SIGNATURE & DATE

☐ I have read this information sheet and discussed it with my child.

☐ I have questions about this unit — please contact me. My contact:

_____

Advanced Water Safety — Parent & Carer Information Sheet · Year 9–10 HPE · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

lsv.com.au · royallifesaving.com.au · victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au

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